

Project Charter: Beacon Migration

Project Sponsor: VP of Engineering, Dana Reyes

Project Lead: Priya Nadella

Start Date: February 2, 2026 Target Completion: May 29, 2026

1. Background

The Beacon service currently runs on a decommissioned internal hosting platform that reaches end-of-life support in Q3 2026. This charter authorizes the migration of Beacon to the company's standard Kubernetes platform before that deadline.

2. Objectives

Migrate all Beacon workloads to Kubernetes with zero data loss, reduce monthly infrastructure cost by at least 20 percent, and establish automated deployment pipelines so future releases no longer require manual server provisioning.

3. Scope

In scope: the Beacon API service, its PostgreSQL database, and the nightly batch reporting job. Out of scope: the Beacon mobile app, which is managed by a separate team and has no infrastructure dependency on this migration.

4. Milestones

Milestone 1 (Feb 20): staging environment fully migrated and passing smoke tests.

Milestone 2 (Mar 31): production database replicated with less than 5 minutes of replication lag. Milestone 3 (Apr 30): production traffic cut over behind a feature flag.

Milestone 4 (May 29): legacy platform decommissioned.

5. Risks

The primary risk is data drift during the cutover window. This is mitigated by running dual writes to both the old and new database for a two-week validation period before the legacy database is retired. A secondary risk is unfamiliarity with Kubernetes among the on-call rotation, mitigated by mandatory training completed before Milestone 3.

6. Approval

This charter requires sign-off from the VP of Engineering, the Head of Infrastructure, and the Beacon service owner before work begins.